Your F.E.A.R. Assessment Results

Where You Stand Before God

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom." — Proverbs 9:10

Thank you for completing the F.E.A.R. Assessment.

This reflection gently reveals where your heart currently stands before God—whether your fear is rightly ordered in reverence toward His true character (producing freedom, intimacy, and peace), or whether some distortions from the enemy still compete for your attention. Fear is a God-given emotion: neutral until directed. Holy fear draws you near to Him; misplaced fear leads toward shame, doubt, or distance. Grace is always inviting realignment, beginning with the fear of the Lord that opens the door to wisdom and culminates in lasting joy.

Your Scores

F – Final Judgment:	**4 Aligned**
E – Eternal Goodness:	**3.9 Emerging**
A – Awe Founded in Beauty & Power:	**3.8 Emerging**
R – Righteous Acts Always:	**4 Aligned**
Overall F.E.A.R. Score:	**3.9 Emerging**

How to Read Your Scores:

- **Aligned (4.0–5.0):** Reverence is well-aligned with God's revealed nature — producing healthy awe, trust, worship, and freedom.
- **Emerging (3.0–3.9):** Reverence is sincerely growing under grace — some competing fears or habits remain, but God is patiently drawing you deeper.
- **Distorted (1.0–2.9):** Fear is often redirected toward lies or created things — God invites gentle redirection toward His truth for healing.

Domain Reflections

F – Final Judgment

Aligned

You live with a steady, grateful awareness that God is the righteous Judge of all. His justice feels clarifying and protective rather than crushing — you rest confidently in the truth that Christ has fully satisfied every demand of justice on your behalf (Romans 8:1). When conviction comes, you turn quickly to Him rather than hide. This sober reverence keeps you walking humbly and transparently before God.

E – Eternal Goodness

Emerging

You believe God is good and that His mercy endures forever, yet in seasons of delay, hardship, or unanswered prayer, that goodness can feel emotionally distant at times. The ancient whisper ("Is God really holding something back?") occasionally surfaces, creating subtle doubt or distance. God is gently inviting you to anchor more deeply in remembrance — recording His past faithfulness so trust can mature into rest. "The Lord is good; His mercy endures forever" (Psalm 100:5).

A – Awe Founded in Beauty & Power

Emerging

You experience moments of genuine wonder at God's beauty and power, yet casualness or fascination with created things may compete at times, dulling reverence. God invites renewal through intentional worship and reflection on His majesty so awe can deepen and swallow lesser fears.

R – Righteous Acts Always

Aligned

You consistently desire and pursue reflecting God's flawless righteousness in your choices — obedience flows from admiration and trust in His perfect ways, producing freedom and integrity even unseen.

Overall Reflection: Emerging

You revere God, but lesser fears still compete. Continued surrender will deepen joy and peace.

Your fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom (Proverbs 9:10), the key that unlocks a rich store of salvation, wisdom, and knowledge—"He will be the sure foundation for your times… the fear of the Lord is the key to this treasure" (Isaiah 33:6). The Lord confides in those who fear Him; He makes His covenant known to them (Psalm 25:14). This reverence opens your heart to God's intimate friendship and delight.

Wisdom is God's gracious gift that confirms His favor upon you. As Ray Stedman teaches in his reflection on Ecclesiastes 8:1, true wisdom makes you a unique original in Christ (not a cheap imitation), grants special insight into life's riddles through knowing God, brightens your face with visible joy from within (grace, not grease), and softens your disposition, making you easier to live with.

This is the worthwhile pathway: holy fear initiates the journey, wisdom matures it through grace, and lasting joy emerges as God delights to give it and be with you. Joy pursued without this foundation—without reverent fear and received wisdom—may prove short-lived, rooted in fleeting circumstances rather than God's unchanging presence.

Grace Reflection

The fear of the Lord was never meant to trap you in anxiety or performance. It is God's loving gift to free you — revealing who He truly is so you can rest securely in His justice, delight in His goodness, stand in wonder at His majesty, and walk humbly in His righteousness. The angel of the Lord encamps around those who fear Him, and He delivers them… Taste and see that the Lord is good; blessed is the one who takes refuge in Him (Psalm 34:7–9). Through Jesus, who bore every judgment and fulfilled every righteous demand, we are welcomed into this holy awe: not withdrawing in terror, but drawing near in confident love with reverence and awe, for we receive a kingdom that cannot be shaken (Hebrews 12:28–29). As A.W. Pink so beautifully reminds us in *The Attributes of God*, the apprehension of God's holiness should fill us with adoring wonder and make us exclaim, "How great is His lovingkindness!". As John Bevere reminds us, "The fear of God swallows up all other fears". And as Ray Stedman illustrates through transformed lives like John Newton's—from wretchedness in the slave trade to radiant hymns of amazing grace—this fear begins the pathway to wisdom's benefits: uniqueness, insight, inner radiance, and a softened heart. Joy alone, without wisdom grounded in reverent fear, risks being temporary; but fear rightly ordered leads to the enduring gladness God is glad to give and share with us.

Prayer

Holy and Gracious Father,
Thank You for being the righteous Judge, the eternally good Father, the majestic King worthy of all awe, and the perfectly righteous One.
Where my fear has drifted toward doubt, casualness, or self-justification, gently redirect my heart.
Begin in me the fear that leads to wisdom—Your grace-gift that makes me unique in Christ, grants insight into life's riddles, brightens my face with lasting joy, and softens my hardness.
Deepen my trust in Your unchanging goodness.
Renew my wonder at Your beauty and power.
Let obedience flow from love rather than striving.
Through Jesus, swallow up every lesser fear and fill me with the peace and radiant joy that come from rightly fearing You.
Amen.

Supplement A: Key Terms & Short Concepts

- **Holy Fear / Fear of the Lord:** Reverent awe that esteems God above all else: trembling wonder, immediate obedience, hatred of sin, and delight in His presence. It is being "terrified of being away from Him" (John Bevere) and the beginning of wisdom (Proverbs 9:10).
- **Counterfeit Fear:** Satan's distortion of a God-given emotion: shame that drives hiding, doubt that breeds suspicion, casual irreverence that dulls wonder, or pride that resists correction.
- **Awe:** Fear transformed by grace: wonder at God's beauty and power that produces worship, purity, intimacy, and freedom from lesser fears.
- **Wisdom:** God's grace-gift received through fearing Him; it brings uniqueness in Christ, insight into life's riddles, visible joy/radiance, and a softened disposition (Ray Stedman on Ecclesiastes 8:1).
- **Judgment:** God's perfect justice that sets all things right; for those in Christ, it is not condemnation but the final vindication of grace.
- **Obedience:** Not rule-keeping to earn love, but the natural fruit of reverence, trust, and admiration for God's righteous ways.

Supplement B: Understanding the Fear of the Lord

Fear is a God-designed emotion — neutral in origin, decisive in outcome. It always captures attention; what we attach it to determines whether it leads to bondage or freedom.

When we rightly fear God, attention moves toward revelation of His character:
Fear → Attention → Revelation of His nature → Repentance / Trust / Worship / Submission → Wisdom (grace-gift from God) → Uniqueness in Christ, Insight into life's riddles, Radiant Joy from within, Softened Heart → Intimacy with God → Lasting Peace and Gladness

"The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom; all who follow his precepts have good understanding. To him belongs eternal praise" (Psalm 111:10).

As Ray Stedman teaches on Ecclesiastes 8:1, wisdom—discovered as we walk in the fear of the Lord—brightens the face with grace-enabled joy (not superficial shine), changes hardness into gentleness, and makes us originals in Christ rather than imitations. This confirms God's favor: He is glad to give wisdom and be with us. Joy pursued independently (e.g., through self, circumstances, or counterfeits) remains shallow and temporary, lacking the depth of God's presence. But through Christ, fear initiates the longer, worthwhile pathway to the joy He delights to share, as seen in John Newton's transformation from wretchedness to radiant hymns of amazing grace.

With the enemy, attentions leads to bondage:
Fear → Attention → Lies about God's nature → Shame / Doubt / Pride / Irreverence → Control / Anxiety / Isolation → Bondage

Holy fear, as John Bevere explains in *The Awe of God*, is not destructive terror that pushes us away — it is reverent awe that draws us near, keeps us from sin (Exodus 20:20), and opens the door to God's manifest presence and confiding friendship (Psalm 25:14).

A.W. Pink writes in *The Attributes of God*, "The fear of God is the soul's instinctive recoil from anything that is loathsome to Him… yet it is ever accompanied with confidence in His mercy and delight in His love." This balance—reverence toward sin + confident joy in mercy—empowers us to approach Him boldly.

The enemy's counterfeits rob us of that intimacy — but grace restores it. Obedience is never the starting goal; it is the beautiful evidence that fear has matured into love, wisdom, and enduring joy.

Recommended Resources

- *The Awe of God* by John Bevere (core text on holy fear transforming life and swallowing lesser fears). johnbevere.com/aweofgod
- *The Holiness of God* by R.C. Sproul. https://store.ligonier.org/the-holiness-of-god-paperback
- *The Attributes of God* by A.W. Pink. https://a.co/d/0c72Nplp
- Ray Stedman's devotional "The Benefits of Wisdom" (Ecclesiastes 7:29–8:1): https://www.raystedman.org/daily-devotions/ecclesiastes/the-benefits-of-wisdom

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